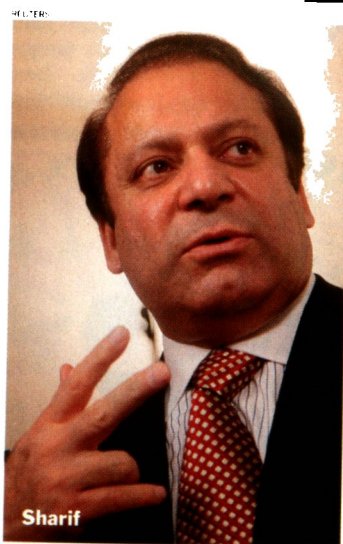


# END

# GAM



■ By Hasan Zaidi in Karachi

In his memoir *In the Line of Fire* published last year, Pakistan's soldier-President had waxed eloquent on the benefits of his exacting commando training. "It taught me that enduring extreme hardship has more to do with mental resilience than physical stamina," he wrote. President General Pervez Musharraf will be hoping that the lessons he had learnt on the frontlines of the army will stand him in good stead in the coming days. Because one way or the other, they are likely to be the most critical days for him.

At stake for General Musharraf is not only his continued role at the helm of affairs in Pakistan but perhaps his very survival. He is faced with a resurgent political opposition that is riding on the back of a popular lawyers' movement against him and an assertive superior judiciary that seems in no mood to compromise. All the recent Supreme Court decisions have gone against him and his Government, and further such decisions are expected. His popularity has plummeted since his futile attempt to sack Chief Justice Iftikhar Muhammad Chaudhry in March and since Pakistani casualties have mounted in the American-mandated "war

GENERAL MUSHARRAF  
FIGHTS FOR SURVIVAL AS  
HIS POPULARITY DWINDLES,  
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UNCOMPROMISING AND  
RELIGIOUS EXTREMISM  
RISES. IS IT TIME UP FOR  
THE PAKISTAN PRESIDENT?

★ Musharraf wants to be re-elected